

The Asian Preferential Trading Arrangement was first proposed by Sri Lanka at the Sixth Summit of SAARC in December, 1991. Under this proposal, SAPTA was signed in 1993 and became operational from December 7, 1995. The **South Asian Free Trade Area (SAPTA)** came into force in its place from January 1, 2006.

30. Match the Column A with Column B and select the correct answer using the codes given below :

| Column A                        | Column B |
|---------------------------------|----------|
| A. National Agricultural Policy | 1. 2004  |
| B. Marine Fishing Policy        | 2. 1978  |
| C. New Foreign Trade Policy     | 3. 2000  |
| D. Seventh Finance Commission   | 4. 2014  |

| A     | B | C | D |
|-------|---|---|---|
| (a) 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| (c) 1 | 4 | 2 | 3 |
| (d) 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |

56<sup>th</sup> to 59<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched columns are as follows :

|                             |   |      |
|-----------------------------|---|------|
| National Agriculture Policy | — | 2000 |
| Marine Fishing Policy       | — | 2004 |
| New Foreign Trade Policy    | — | 2014 |
| Seventh Finance Commission  | — | 1978 |

31. India's first textile university will be set up in which of the following States?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Bihar  
(c) Gujarat (d) Odisha  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60<sup>th</sup> to 62<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

In 2016, the Gujarat government announced its plan to set up India's first textile university in Surat (Gujarat) with an investment of about Rs. 800 – 900 crore.

32. In how many adhikarnas is the Kautilya Arthashastra divided?

- (a) 11 (b) 12  
(c) 14 (d) 15

48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Kautilya Arthashastra is divided into 15 adhikarnas.

33. Which country has recently signed a free trade agreement (FTA) with the United Arab Emirates?

- (a) Israel (b) Australia

- (c) Italy (d) Pakistan  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

A free trade agreement between Israel and the United Arab Emirates was signed on 31<sup>st</sup> May, 2022. This is the first time Israel has signed a free trade agreement with a Arab Country.

## D. DEMOGRAPHY

### India : Population

1. Which of the following statements is true?

- (a) As per the 2011 Census, Sikkim has a population of 6 lakhs.  
(b) Uttar Pradesh is the largest State in India in terms of area.  
(c) India accounts for 2.6 percent of the world's area.  
(d) More than one of the above  
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (a)

India is the seventh country in the world (area) which occupies about 2.4% of the world's area with the area of 32, 87,263 sq.km. As per the 2011 census, Sikkim is the smallest populous state in Indian States with the population of 610577 lakh and Uttar Pradesh is the largest state in India in terms of population (199812341) and fourth largest state in terms of area 240928 square kilometer.

2. Which one of the following is the most significant feature of the Indian population?

- (a) Declining birthrate  
(b) Improvement in health conditions  
(c) Improvement in the literacy level  
(d) The size of its adolescent population  
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)

The most significant feature of the Indian population is the size of its adolescent population.

Its adolescent population, aged 10-19 years, accounts for a substantial portion of the national total, some 253 million. This demographic segment is a significant part of what economists and demographers have come to call the 'demographic dividend'

3. The total population of India is-

- (a) 1,027,015,247 (b) 1,028,737,436  
(c) 10,12,52,751 (d) None of the above

48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

According to the census 2001, the total population of India was 1,028,737,436, while according to the final data of Census 2011, the population of India is 1210854977, in which the male population is 623724248 and the female population is 586469174. The population density of India is 382 persons per sq km. And the sex ratio is 943 (females per thousand males).

4. What is the minimum age of a person whose photographing, fingerprinting and iris mapping will be done for the Census of 2011?

- (a) 12 years (b) 15 years  
(c) 18 years (d) 21 years

53<sup>rd</sup> to 55<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

The minimum age of a person whose photographing, fingerprinting and iris mapping to be done for the Census of 2011 was 15 years. This was the part of the work to be done under the **National Population Register** (NPR).

5. According to the latest census the average annual population growth rate of India is-

- (a) showed an increasing trend  
(b) showed a declining trend  
(c) grew explosively  
(d) remained constant

42<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997-98

Ans. (b)

The average annual growth rate of population between 1971 and 1981 was 2.25%, while the average annual growth rate of population during the period 1981-91 was 2.14%. Therefore, the average annual growth rate of population between 1981-91 showed a declining trend. As per the latest, Census 2011, the average annual growth rate of population has come down to 1.64%.

6. The percentage of decadal growth of population during 2001-2011 as per Census 2011 is :

- (a) 21.54 (b) 17.64  
(c) 15.89 (d) 19.21  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60<sup>th</sup> to 62<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

As per final data of Census 2011, the percentage of decadal growth of population during 2001-2011 is 17.7%. However, as per provisional data of Census 2011, it was at 17.64%.

7. Which Census year is called 'Demographic Divide' in the population study of India?

- (a) 1911 (b) 1921  
(c) 1931 (d) 1941  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

The year 1921 has been the only Census year in the history of the Indian Census in which the decadal growth rate of population was negative (-0.31%). After that year population of India gradually registered accelerated growth. Hence, 1921 is called as the year of 'Great Divide'.

8. As per Census 2011, what is the rank of Bihar State in terms of population in the country?

- (a) I (b) II  
(c) III (d) IV  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60<sup>th</sup> to 62<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

As per Census 2011, the total population of Bihar is 104099452 and its rank is III after Uttar Pradesh (199812341) and Maharashtra (112374333) in terms of population in the country.

9. Urban population of India is equal to ..... percentage of the total population.

- (a) 25.72 (b) 31.86  
(c) 20.28 (d) 22.52

44<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

According to the National Census 1991, the urban population in India was 25.72% of the total population. According to the final figures of the current census 2011, the urban population of India is 31.1% of the total population.

10. According to the 1991 census, the population of India is-

- (a) 80.2 crores (b) 82.2 percent  
(c) 84.4 crores (d) 88.5 crores

40<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

According to the 1991 census, the population of India was 846.4 million. As per 2011 census, the population has increased to 1210854977, i.e. decadal growth rate stood at 17.7% of population during 2001-2011.

**11. According to 2001 Census --- percent population of India lives in Bihar State.**

- (a) 8 (b) 10  
(c) 11 (d) 12

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (a)**

Bihar is the third largest state in terms of population. As per Census 2001, the total population of Bihar was 82998509. Thus, 8.07 percent of total population of India was inhabited in Bihar. As per Census 2011, about 9 percent of India's population (104099452) is inhabited in Bihar.

**12. Bihar is the ---- largest state of India according to 2001 Census.**

- (a) Second (b) Third  
(c) Fourth (d) Fifth

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of the above question.

**13. According to 2001 Census, what is the total population of Bihar?**

- (a) 82998509 (b) 76210007  
(c) 96878627 (d) 80176197

**53<sup>rd</sup> to 55<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011**

**Ans. (a)**

See the explanation of the above question.

**14. Consider the following statements about the population characteristics of India :**

- I. During 1991 - 2001 decade the population grew at the rate of nearly 21 percent.**  
**II. In 2001 the gap between male and female literacy has widened as compared to 1991.**  
**III. As per the 2001 Census there are 35 large cities in the country which accommodate nearly 48 percent of total urban population.**  
**IV. The 1991 census reflected a decline in the number of unproductive consumers.**

**Which of these statements are correct?**

- (a) I and II  
(b) II and III  
(c) I and IV  
(d) II, III and IV

**47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005**

**Ans. (c)**

The growth rate of population in the decade 1991-2001 was 21.54 percent. The difference between male and female literacy in 1991 was 24.8 percent, while it was reduced to 21.6 percent in 2001. As per Census 2001, 48 percent of the Urban population did not live in 35 big cities. According to the World Bank Data, there has been a trend of reduction in India's dependency ratio since 1966. Hence, statements I and IV are correct while statement II and III are incorrect.

**15. Ratio of total Population to total area is called**

- (a) sex ratio  
(b) literacy rate  
(c) density of population  
(d) More than one of the above  
(e) None of the above

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**Ans. (c)**

Population density is calculated as the number of persons per unit area. India is one of the most densely populated countries of the World. The ratio between the number of women and men in the population is called the sex ratio. In India, it is calculated as the number of females per thousand males. The literacy rate is defined by the percentage of population of given age group that can read and write.

**16. According to the Census 2001, the density of population in India (per sq. km) is :**

- (a) 304 (b) 324  
(c) 344 (d) 364

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (b)**

Population density is the number of individuals per unit geographic area. (e.g. sq. Km) As per Census 2001, India's population density was 324 persons per sq. km, which as per Census 2011 is increased to 382 persons per sq. km. It is noteworthy that according to the Census 2011, the population density figure of India was revised to 325 for the year 2001.

**17. Which one of the following States has the highest density of population according to the Census of India, 2011?**

- (a) Kerala  
(b) Haryana  
(c) Bihar  
(d) Uttar Pradesh  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**64<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (c)**

According to the Census 2001, West Bengal had the highest population density, which was 903 and Arunachal Pradesh had the lowest population density (13). As per Census 2011, India's most densely populated State is Bihar (1106 persons per sq. km) and the State with the lowest population density is Arunachal Pradesh (17 persons per sq. km).

**18. Which state has the maximum population density?**

- (a) Kerala (b) Uttar Pradesh  
(c) West Bengal (d) Maharashtra

**44<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000**

**Ans. (c)**

Option (c) was the correct answer during the question period. According to the 2011 census, Bihar (1106) has the highest population density in India.

**19. Which district of Bihar recorded the highest density of population (per sq. km) as per 2011 Census?**

- (a) Sheohar (b) Vaishali  
(c) Patna (d) Darbhanga  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**65<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019**

**Ans. (a)**

As per 2011 Census, Sheohar (1880 per sq. km) has recorded the highest density of population among all districts of Bihar.

**20. According to the 2001 census, which is the state with the highest total urban population?**

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Maharashtra  
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Kerala

**40<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995**

**Ans. (b)**

According to the final figures of the National Census 2001, the state with the highest urban population was Maharashtra. According to the census of the year 2011, the figures of urban population are as follows-

| State population | Total urban population | Percentage of urban in total state population |
|------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Maharashtra      | 50818259               | 45.2%                                         |
| Uttar Pradesh    | 44495063               | 45.2%                                         |
| Tamil Nadu       | 34917440               | 48.4%                                         |
| Kerala           | 15934926               | 47.7%                                         |

The country's urbanization is 31.1%, while the least urbanized states are Himachal Pradesh (10%), Bihar (11.3%) and Assam (14.1%).

**21. The increase in literacy rate in India during 1991-2001 is :**

- (a) 10.8% (b) 12.6%  
(c) 14.3% (d) 15.5%

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (b)**

The increase in literacy rate in India during 1991-2001 was 12.6 percent.

**22. Which state of India has the highest population density?**

- (a) Delhi (b) West Bengal  
(c) Kerala (d) Uttar Pradesh

**45<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001-02**

**Ans. (a)**

In the given question, option (a) was correct answer. At present, the given state's population density is as follows (as per census 2011) – West Bengal (1028), Delhi (11,320), Kerala (860) and Uttar Pradesh (829).

**23. As per Census 2011 the female literacy rate in India was :**

- (a) 60.0 percent (b) 63.0 percent  
(c) 65.5 percent (d) 68.5 percent  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**64<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018**

**Ans. (e)**

As per final data of Census 2011, the female literacy rate in India was 64.6 percent while male literacy rate was at 80.9 percent. However, according to the provisional data of Census 2011, the female literacy rate in India was 65.46 percent.

**24. According to Indian Population Census 2011, the percentage of literacy among males and females both is lowest for the State of :**

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh  
(b) Andhra Pradesh  
(c) Bihar  
(d) Jammu and Kashmir  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017**

**Ans. (c)**

As per Census 2011, the percentage of literacy among males and females for the State of Bihar was 71.2% and 51.5% respectively, which both is lowest among all States/UTs of India.

25. According to the last census report, the population growth rate of India was-

- (a) 129.9% (b) 84.25%  
(c) 254% (d) None of the above

41<sup>st</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

According to the last census report in 1991, India's population growth was 23.85% (decadal). Decadal growth rate of population in 2001-2011 as per the final data of National Census 2011 was 17.7%.

26. Which among the following States has a lower literacy rate than the country's average literacy rate according to 2001 Census?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Gujarat  
(c) Odisha (d) West Bengal

47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

As per Census 2001 and also according to Census 2011, among the given States, Odisha has a lower literacy rate than the country's average literacy rate. As per Census 2011, Odisha has a literacy rate of 72.87 percent, which is still lower than the national average (74.04%).

27. As per Census 2011, which State has the lowest sex-ratio?

- (a) Punjab (b) Haryana  
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Bihar  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60-62<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

As per Census 2011, Haryana has the lowest sex-ratio (879) among all States of India.

| State         | Sex-Ratio (2011) |
|---------------|------------------|
| Haryana       | 879              |
| Punjab        | 895              |
| Uttar Pradesh | 912              |
| Bihar         | 918              |

28. The district of Bihar which has recorded the highest sex-ratio as per the 2011 Census is :

- (a) Siwan (b) Gopalganj  
(c) Saran (d) Kishanganj

- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

As per the 2011 Census, Gopalganj (1021) has recorded the highest sex-ratio among all districts of Bihar.

29. As per the Census 2011, the child sex-ratio in Bihar was:

- (a) 935 (b) 934  
(c) 933 (d) 932  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

As per the final data of Census 2011, the child (0-6 years) sex-ratio in Bihar was 935.

30. The States/Union Territories of India having the highest percentage of SC and ST population in their total population as per 2011 Census are

- (a) Uttar Pradesh and Mizoram  
(b) West Bengal and Nagaland  
(c) Punjab and Lakshadweep  
(d) Bihar and Meghalaya  
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes comprise about 16.6% and 8.6% of Indian population (According to the 2011 census). Punjab had the highest percentage of its population as Scheduled Castes and Lakshadweep and Mizoram had the highest percentage of its population as Scheduled Tribes.

31. Which of the following States has the largest number of people belonging to Scheduled Caste?

- (a) Bihar (b) West Bengal  
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Punjab

53<sup>rd</sup> to 55<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

As per Census 2011, top 5 States with highest Scheduled Castes population in descending order are as follows :  
1. Uttar Pradesh (41357608), 2. West Bengal (21463270),  
3. Bihar (16567325), 4. Tamil Nadu (14438445), 5. Andhra Pradesh (13878078).

**32. The State of India with the highest percentage of tribal population to its total population as per the 2011 Census is:**

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh      (b) Nagaland
- (c) Mizoram                      (d) Meghalaya
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

**66<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020**

**Ans. (c)**

As per 2011 Census, the highest percentage of tribal population to its total population is in Mizoram (94.4%) among all the States in India, while among the Union Territories, it is highest in Lakshadweep (94.8%).

**33. According to the Census of India, 2011, which Scheduled Tribe is largest in India?**

- (a) Sandia                      (b) Kol
- (c) Bhil                          (d) Gond
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**67<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)2021**

**Ans. (c)**

According to the Census of 2011, Bhil scheduled tribe is largest in India (17071049) and Gond tribal population (13256928) is next in the sequence.

**34. Which State has the highest number of fully covered tribal habitations with the safe drinking water?**

- (a) Madhya Pradesh      (b) Odisha
- (c) Rajasthan              (d) Jharkhand
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017**

**Ans. (a)**

Among all Indian States, Madhya Pradesh has the highest number of tribal habitations (55770) fully covered with the safe drinking water facility.

**35. What does infant mortality rate refer to?**

- (a) The ratio of number of children who die before their fifth birthday out of every 1000 live births
- (b) The ratio of number of children who die before their first birthday out of every 1000 live births
- (c) The ratio of number of children who die before their fifth birthday out of every 100 live births
- (d) The ratio of number of children who die before their first birthday out of every 100 live births

**56<sup>th</sup> to 59<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (b)**

The **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)**, which is widely accepted as a crude indicator of the overall health scenario of a country or a region, is defined as the infant deaths (less than one year) per thousand (1000) live births in a given time period (generally during a year) and for a given region. Hence, both of the given statements are incorrect.

**Note :** The current infant mortality rate for India in 2024 is 25.799 deaths per 1000 live births.

- The IMR for India in 2023 was 26.619 deaths per 1000 live births.

**36. Which State has topped the list of States with most number of beggars, as per data released by the Union Ministry of Social Justice?**

- (a) West Bengal              (b) Andhra Pradesh
- (c) Bihar                          (d) Uttar Pradesh
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017**

**Ans. (a)**

According to the data released by the Union Ministry of Social Justice in March 2018, there are total 413670 beggars in the country as per Census 2011. The highest number of beggars is in West Bengal (81244) which is followed by Uttar Pradesh (65835). SMILE Scheme has been started for the persons engage in the act of begging.

**37. In the following P.I.O. card scheme is related to-**

- (i) It means persons of Indian origin who have residence abroad.
- (ii) Visa is required for P.I.O. card holders.
- (iii) It includes residents of Bangladesh and Pakistan.
- (iv) They can avail facilities to acquire, hold, exchange and sell immovable property, including agricultural and plantation property, anywhere in India.

- (a) (i) and (ii) only              (b) (i), (ii) and (iii) only
- (c) only (i)                          (d) all four

**43<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999**

**Ans. (c)**

P.I.O. (Person of Indian Origin) card scheme from the given options only the first option matches. P.I.O. Card holders will not require a visa to visit India. Citizens of Bangladesh and Pakistan P.I.O. Card will not be allotted. P.I.O. cardholder can avail the facilities of acquisition, possession, exchange and sale of immovable property anywhere in India except agricultural and plantation properties.